

Mod List V3 — Minecraft 1.21.1 NeoForge

Wave -1 — Prerequisites

JDK 21

Tool	Role
Eclipse Temurin JDK 21 (LTS)	Java runtime and development kit for Minecraft 1.21.1

Install the **JDK** (not just JRE) — the JDK includes `javac` and `jlink` needed by NeoForge. Minimum version 21.0.0, any LTS build. On Windows, use the MSI installer and ensure `JAVA_HOME` is set to the install path (e.g., `C:\Program Files\Eclipse Adoptium\jdk-21.0.6.13-hotspot`). On Linux/macOS, use your package manager (`apt install temurin-21-jdk`, `brew install temurin21`).

Verify installation:

```
java -version
# Expected: openjdk version "21.0.x" ...
```

Performance Tuning

Recommended JVM arguments (for Modrinth App → instance → Settings → Java & Memory → JVM Arguments, or Minecraft Launcher → Installation → Edit → More Options → JVM Arguments):

```
-XX:+UseZGC -XX:+ZGenerational -Xms8G -Xmx8G
```

System RAM	Recommended allocation
16 GB	-Xms10G -Xmx10G
32 GB	-Xms22G -Xmx22G
64 GB	-Xms48G -Xmx48G

Note: ZGC (Z Garbage Collector) with generational mode is the recommended GC for Java 21 with NeoForge. It provides consistently low latency (sub-millisecond pause times) and handles the large heap sizes common with modded Minecraft better than Shenandoah or G1GC. The Adoptium Temurin JDK 21 includes ZGC — no special Java build needed. If you encounter issues, you may also add `-XX:+AlwaysPreTouch` for pre-initialized memory pages.

Modrinth App

Tool	Role
Modrinth App	Mod manager and launcher for the modpack

The **Modrinth App** manages mod installation, updates, and launching for this modpack. It creates a separate instance per modpack, handles NeoForge installation automatically, and lets you install mods in one click from Modrinth's database. All Wave 0+ mods in this pack are available on Modrinth.

Setup:

1. Download and install the [Modrinth App](#) for your OS.
2. Create a new **instance** (type: "Vanilla" → select version **1.21.1**).
3. Open the instance's settings → **Modloader** → select **NeoForge** (latest recommended for 1.21.1).
4. Click **Install** — the app downloads NeoForge automatically.
5. Launch the instance once to generate the `mods/` directory and configs.
6. Verify the main menu shows "NeoForge X.X.X" in the bottom-left corner.

From there, add mods through the app's **Browse** tab or by dropping `.jar` files into the instance's `mods/` folder. All mod links in this document link to their Modrinth pages — click to install directly.

Minecraft 1.21.1

Install the **Minecraft 1.21.1** vanilla client from the official launcher:

1. Open the [Minecraft Launcher](#).
2. Create a new installation with version **release 1.21.1**.
3. Run it once to generate the vanilla `versions/` and `libraries/` directories, then close.
4. Locate your Minecraft directory:
 - Windows: `%APPDATA%\minecraft`
 - Linux: `~/.minecraft`
 - macOS: `~/Library/Application Support/minecraft`

NeoForge

Tool	Role
NeoForge	Mod loader for Minecraft 1.21.1

NeoForge is the mod loader powering this modpack. If you're using the **Modrinth App**, it installs NeoForge automatically when you set the modloader in the instance settings (see [Modrinth App](#) above) — skip to step 5 to verify.

If installing manually:

1. Download the **NeoForge installer** for Minecraft 1.21.1 from [neoforged.net](#).
2. Run the installer: `java -jar neoforge-1.21.1-<version>-installer.jar`.
3. Select **"Install client"** and point it to your Minecraft directory (auto-detected on most systems).
4. Launch the new **neoforge** profile in the Minecraft Launcher once to generate the `mods/` directory and NeoForge configs.
5. Verify the main menu shows "NeoForge X.X.X" in the bottom-left corner.

Important: Do not add any mod `.jar` files yet. Wave -1 is complete when the vanilla 1.21.1 client runs under NeoForge with no mods installed.

Wave 0 — Foundation

Performance & Rendering

Mod	Role
Sodium	Rendering engine
Iris	Shader loader (v1.8.14, NeoForge native)
Lithium	Server-side game logic optimization
Distant Horizons	LOD rendering
ModernFix	All-in-one perf + bug fixes
ImmediatelyFast	Immediate-mode rendering
Entity Culling	Hide off-screen entities
Dynamic FPS	Background FPS reduction
NoisiumForked (v2.7.0)	Worldgen optimization (active fork)
FerriteCore	Memory usage reduction

Visual & Client QoL

Mod	Role
LambDynamicLights	Dynamic lighting
BetterF3	Customizable debug HUD
Sound Physics Remastered	Realistic sound
AmbientSounds	Nature ambiance (birds, wind, water)
The Immersive Music Mod	147 new biome/structure-based songs, vanilla silence gaps preserved
Immersive UI	Animated UI, smooth hotbar, item particles
Traveler's Titles	RPG-style titles entering biomes/dimensions
Better Modlist	Enhanced mod list screen with badges/categories
Better Third Person	Independent 360° camera rotation in third-person view
Tooltip Overhaul	Modern, sharp tooltip rendering with equipment compare
Sounds	170+ new sound effects for UIs, items, blocks, actions
Tiny Item Animations	Subtle float/pulse animations on inventory items

Inventory & UI

Mod	Role
JEI	Recipe viewer
Jade	Block info HUD
Jade Addons (Neo/Forge)	Extra Jade info panels
Xaero's Minimap	Minimal map, entity radar, waypoints
Xaero's World Map	Full-screen world map with explored area overlay
AppleSkin	Food hunger/saturation overlay
Mouse Tweaks	Inventory management shortcuts
Fancy Toasts	Beautiful animated advancement popups
Obscure Tooltips	Animated tooltips with 3D models and particles
Loot Journal	Animated item pickup notifications
Reliable Advancements	Overhauled advancements UI with editor/pan/zoom
Polymorph	Choose crafting result when recipes conflict
Mod Name Tooltip	Shows which mod an item comes from in tooltip

Storage & Travel

Mod	Role
Sophisticated Storage	Upgradable barrels/chests
Sophisticated Backpacks	Portable inventory
Waystones	Fast travel between waypoints
GraveStone Mod	Keep inventory on death

Infrastructure

Mod	Role
Chunk Loaders	Keep chunks loaded across dimensions — essential for Phase 2+ automation
SuperMartijn642's Config Lib	Config library (Chunk Loaders dependency)
SuperMartijn642's Core Lib	Core library (Chunk Loaders dependency)

New Dependencies

Mod	Role
Cloth Config	Config screen library
Architecture API	Cross-loader compatibility
YACL	Config library
Curios API	Accessory slots (replaces Trinkets)
CreativeCore	Library (AmbientSounds)
OctoLib	Library (Immersive UI)
Fragmentum	Library (Obscure Tooltips, Loot Journal)
M.R.U	Library (Sounds)
YUNG's API	Library (Traveler's Titles, YUNG's Better mods)

Shaderpack

Shaderpack	Description
Complementary Unbound	Realistic visual style, Potato→Ultra profiles, block-specific effects

Optimal settings for NVIDIA RTX 4080 SUPER (16GB VRAM, 4K target):

Setting	Value
Visual Style	Unbound
Profile	Ultra
RP Support	Integrated PBR+
Real-Time Shadows	Very High
Shadow Distance	20 chunks
Light Shaft Quality	High
Entity Shadows	OFF
Detail Quality	High
Cloud Quality	High
Water Reflection Quality	Medium (max)
Block Reflection Quality	High
Anti-Aliasing (FXAA)	ON
Edge Shadow (SSAO) Quality	High (max)
Advanced Colored Lighting	16 chunks
Texture Filtering	16x

General MC settings: Render Distance 20–24 chunks, Fullscreen ON, VSync OFF, Max Framerate uncapped. Expected ~100+ FPS at 4K with Faithful 64 texture pack. With 128x+ texture packs, monitor VRAM usage (peaks at ~14GB). Drop to High profile if targeting 144Hz+.

Texture Packs

Pack	Role
Faithful 64x	64x vanilla block textures — clean, sharp, PBR-compatible with Complementary Unbound
Fresh Animations	Living entity animation overhaul — mobs blink, look around, show emotion
RAY's 3D Rails	3D block & item textures for all rail types
3D Ladders	3D model replacement for ladders
Better Lanterns	Enhanced 3D look for lanterns and chains

Faithful 64x upscales vanilla blocks to 64x resolution while preserving the original look. Works with Complementary Unbound's Integrated PBR+ for realistic material response (metal shines, wool is soft, stone is rough). Modded blocks (Create, Mekanism, AE2) use their default textures, which are already well-designed and blend naturally at 64x. The RTX 4080 SUPER handles this with zero FPS impact at 4K.

Fresh Animations adds idle animations, directional looking, sleep/blink cycles, and emotional states to all vanilla mobs. It's a resource pack overlay (not a mod) — place it **above** Faithful 64x in the pack order. Works on any version with no mod dependencies.

RAY's 3D Rails replaces rail block and item textures with 3D models. Supports shaders since v3.0. Compatible with all rail types from Steam 'n' Rails and Create.

3D Ladders replaces the vanilla ladder model with a 3D version. Simple, lightweight, no conflicts.

Better Lanterns gives lanterns and chains an enhanced 3D look with connected chain models. Compatible with Arcane Lanterns and Thin Air mods.

Installation: Download each [.zip](#) above, place in [.minecraft/resourcepacks/](#), then enable them in Options → Resource Packs. Suggested load order (top = highest priority):

1. Faithful 64x
2. Fresh Animations
3. RAY's 3D Rails
4. 3D Ladders
5. Better Lanterns

Configuration — Wave 0

Waystones:

- `inventoryButton = "any"` — Opens waystone menu from inventory without a keybind.
- `enableCosts = false` — Free teleportation.

- `enableCooldowns = false` — No teleport cooldown.

Tombstone (GraveStone Mod):

- `grave.keepExperience = true` — Keep all XP on death. Complements the Skill Tree (Wave 3).
- `grave.protectionDuration = 86400` — 24 hours of grave protection.

Aether:

- `"Use default Curios' menu" = true` — Uses Curios API menu instead of Aether's separate accessories screen.
- `"Gives player Aether Portal Frame item" = false` — Player must build the portal manually.
- `"Gives starting loot on entry" = true` — Grants Book of Lore and Golden Parachutes on first entry.
- `"Show Patreon message" = false` — Removes Patreon nag screen.
- `"Add Temporary Freezing automatically" = false` — Disables Aether's temporary freezing datapack.
- `"Add Ruined Portals automatically" = false` — Disables ruined portal datapack.

Loot Journal:

- `writeSessionJson = true` — Saves per-session gain/loss data.
- `writeStatisticsJson = true` — Builds cumulative drop statistics.
- `showSummaryOnDisconnect = true` — Shows session summary on disconnect.

Data Packs (Wave 0)

Data Pack	Role
BlazeandCave's Advancements Pack (v2.3.0 for 1.21.x)	1000+ new advancements across 16 tabs

BlazeandCave's Advancements Pack adds 1000+ milestones across 16 themed tabs — mining, building, farming, combat, exploration, redstone, brewing, enchantments, and more. It tracks collecting every wood variant, killing every mob type, discovering every biome, and reaching tier milestones. Runs alongside Reliable Advancements (GUI overhaul) and Fancy Toasts (animated popups) without conflict.

Installation: Drop the `.zip` into your world's `datapacks/` folder (`saves/<world>/datapacks/`), then run `/datapack enable "blazeandcave/advancements"`. The pack is per-world — enable it in each new world.

Wave 1 — Tech (Create + Mekanism + AE2)

The classic tech trio. Create handles mechanical automation, Mekanism handles industrial processing, AE2 handles digital storage and autocrafting.

Core Tech

Mod	Role
Create 6.0.10	Mechanical automation — rotational power, water wheels, windmills, gear trains, conveyor belts, deployers, sequenced crafters, trains

Mod	Role
Mekanism 10.7.19.85	Industrial processing — ore multiplication (2x→5x), digital miner, fusion reactor, superdense energy storage, MekaSuit (flight, invulnerability)
AE2 19.2.17	Digital storage — ME drives, autocrafting, P2P tunnels, spatial storage. The storage backbone

Create Addons

Mod	Role
Create Crafts & Additions 1.6.0	Electric motors, alternators, rolling mill, wires/rods, silver/electrum — bridges kinetic SU and Forge Energy (FE)
Steam 'n' Rails NeoForge 0.2.1	Expanded train system — new tracks (spruce, monorail), semaphores, conductor mob, coupling/decoupling blocks
Create: The Factory Must Grow (TFMG)	Heavy engineering & oil — crude oil drilling, distillation, diesel/gasoline/LPG engines, steel, aluminum, electricity with voltage
Mekanism TFMG Compatibility	85+ recipe bridges — deduplicates lead/steel/sulfur, integrates aluminum/plastic into Mekanism chains

How They Work Together

Layer	Mod
Power generation	Create (water wheels, windmills, steam) + Mekanism (advanced generators, fusion reactor)
Ore processing	Mekanism — up to 5x ore multiplication with chemical processing
Factory automation	Create — conveyor belts, deployers, sequenced crafters
Storage	AE2 — ME drives, storage busses, crafting CPUs
Transport	Create trains + AE2 P2P tunnels
Endgame	Mekanism fusion reactor + MekaSuit + AE2 autocrafting
	#### Ores

Mod	Role
Create (built-in)	Zinc, brass, copper
Mekanism (built-in)	Osmium, tin, lead, uranium, fluorite
Skniro's Nether & End Ores	Additional ores in Nether and End dimensions

Configuration — Wave 1

Mekanism ([config/Mekanism/general.toml](#)):

- `allowChunkloading = false` — Disable Mekanism's built-in chunk loading. Prevents conflict with the dedicated Chunk Loaders mod and keeps chunk management unified.

Ore generation: All default rates. Osmium at iron-like frequency, tin/lead moderate, uranium/fluorite rarer. Default distribution aligns with the pack's progression curve.

Interdependency notes for Wave 1:

- Mekanism's universal cables can power AE2 controllers via the Energy Acceptor. No adapter mod needed.
- **Create Crafts & Additions** electric motors and alternators create a direct kinetic↔FE bridge, replacing the Create Alternator workaround. Silver and electrum add new material tiers that integrate with Mekanism's ore processing line.
- **Steam 'n' Rails** expands Create's train system with new tracks, semaphores, conductor mobs, and coupling blocks. Essential for moving resources between MineColonies, Mekanism factories, and AE2 storage across a sprawling base.
- Mekanism's 5x ore processing (Chemical Dissolution Chamber → Washer → Crystallizer) outclasses Create's Crushing Wheels (1.5x) and Millstone (1x) for ore multiplication. This is intentional — Create handles mechanical automation and component crafting, Mekanism handles industrial processing. Neither obsoletes the other.
- AE2's Storage Bus on a Sophisticated Storage barrel makes early-mid game storage migration seamless. Place a Storage Bus on your barrel wall, configure it to show contents in the ME terminal, and transition gradually to full digital storage.
- **Create: The Factory Must Grow** adds oil drilling, distillation towers, blast furnaces, and diesel engines — expanding Create's mechanical toolkit into heavy industry. Its steel replaces Mekanism's steel (TFMG's blast furnace is the intended steel source; Mekanism's steel recipe is disabled by the Mekanism TFMG Compat mod). TFMG aluminum and plastic feed into Mekanism's advanced processing chains.
- **Mekanism TFMG Compatibility** resolves 85+ recipe overlaps between TFMG and Mekanism — lead, sulfur, and steel are unified under TFMG's production lines, while Mekanism retains its chemical processing advantage. Both JEI item blacklist config and per-recipe toggles are available for pack tuning.
- **Create: TFMG — Stellaris Compat** (listed in Wave 7) allows TFMG diesel and gasoline to fuel Stellaris rockets, creating a direct fuel-production pipeline from TFMG refineries to space launch. This bridges Wave 1 heavy industry with Wave 7 space exploration.

Wave 1.5 — Colony Management

MineColonies provides autonomous NPC workers that mine, farm, craft, and guard your base.

Colony Automation

Mod	Role
MineColonies	Autonomous NPC colony — builders, miners, farmers, crafters, guards, research tree
Structurize	Structure building/placement library (MineColonies dependency)
MultiPiston	Multi-block piston library (MineColonies dependency)

Mod	Role
BlockUI	UI library (MineColonies dependency)
Domum Ornamentum	Decorative block library (MineColonies dependency)

Interdependency notes for Wave 1.5

- MineColonies guards (deployed via the Town Hall's "Guard Tower" building) patrol your base perimeter, reducing the need to secure every wall gap manually. Their effectiveness scales with the Guard Tower level and the colony's skill research. This creates a natural progression — automated base defense grows as your colony does.
- MineColonies Colony Research milestones signal Phase 2 progression readiness. For example, the "Industrial Revolution" research (Colony level 3, 5000 research points) serves as a soft gate — by the time you reach it, you have the colony infrastructure to support Mekanism and AE2. Hard recipe gating (e.g., Atomic Alloy locked behind research) requires a data pack or scripting mod and is not implemented in this pack — the progression pillars in AGENTS.md define the intent, and playtesting determines if soft gating is sufficient.
- Chunk Loaders (Wave 0) are essential for MineColonies — they keep workers active while you explore other dimensions. Place at least one at your colony after setting up your base.

Wave 2 — Exploration (World & Dimensions)

Overworld Worldgen

Mod	Role
Terralith	Overhauled Overworld biomes
Tectonic	Better terrain shape — deeper valleys, taller mountains, cliffs

Structures

Mod	Role
YUNG's Better Dungeons	Overhauled dungeons
YUNG's Better Mineshafts	Improved mineshafts
YUNG's Better Strongholds	Larger, more complex strongholds
YUNG's Better Desert Temples	Multi-room desert temples
YUNG's Better Jungle Temples	Jungle temples with traps
YUNG's Better Ocean Monuments	Redesigned ocean monuments
YUNG's Better Witch Huts	Expanded witch huts
YUNG's Better Nether Fortresses	Improved nether fortresses

Mod	Role
YUNG's Better Caves	Larger, more varied caves
Structory	New hand-crafted structures
Towns & Towers	Better village generation

Dimensions

Mod	Role
The Aether	Sky dimension — safe islands, gear progression, dungeons with bosses
Deeper and Darker	The "Otherside" dimension — deep dark themed, warden gear
Twilight Forest	Classic dimension — 6+ bosses with progression gates, unique loot, enchanted forest biomes

End Overhaul

Mod	Role
BetterEnd NeoForge v21.0.25	Full End overhaul — 24+ biomes, new mobs, gear, custom music
Moog's End Structures v2.0.3	New structures to fill the End dimension

New Dependencies (End Overhaul)

Mod	Role
BCLib NeoForge	Core library — required by BetterEnd
WorldWeaver NeoForge	Worldgen library — required by BetterEnd
WunderLib NeoForge	Utility library — required by BetterEnd
Moog's Structure Lib	Library — required by Moog's End Structures
Cristel Lib	Library — required by Towns & Towers

Navigation

Mod	Role
Explorer's Compass	Craftable structure/biome finder

Mobility

Mod	Role
Immersive Aircraft 1.1.5	Flyable aircraft — biplane, airship, cargo airship, warship, gyrocopter. Upgradable, colorable

The Aether: Configuration covered in Wave 0.

Interdependency note — Immersive Aircraft + Aether: Aircraft can fly in the Aether dimension. An airship is a natural way to navigate Aether islands — it pairs well with the dimension's sky-island geography.

Interdependency note — Twilight Forest + Apotheosis: Apotheosis boss affixes (Wave 3) apply to Twilight Forest bosses. A Naga with the "Tough" affix is significantly harder. This is intended — it keeps dimension bosses relevant even with late-game gear. If a boss feels too strong, the player can return after better equipment or use Apotheosis gems/runes for the edge.

Interdependency note — Towns & Towers + Cristel Lib: Towns & Towers requires **Cristel Lib** (included in Wave 2 Dependencies above). Without it the game will crash at startup. Cristel Lib provides structure config and runtime datapack support that Towns & Towers relies on for its biome-specific village variants.

Wave 3 — Equipment Magic & RPG

RPG Progression

Mod	Role
Skill Tree (RPG Series)	XP leveling — spend points on attributes and passives
Pufferfish's Skills	Underlying skill system framework

Equipment

Mod	Role
Simply Swords	60+ unique weapons with passive/activated abilities
Relics RPG	Legendary accessories with unique abilities
Runes	Socketable runes for weapons/tools
Curios API	Accessory slots (rings, amulets, belts, gloves)

Loot & Affixes

Mod	Role
Apotheosis	Rarity tiers, random affixes, gem socketing, enchanting overhaul. Replaces Savaru's Affixology with more depth

Configuration — Wave 3

Apotheosis — the most config-heavy major mod. Apotheosis is split into modules, each with its own config:

Adventure module — affixes, gems, boss modifiers, rogue spawners:

- Keep all affix types enabled: Ruthless (crit), Arcane (spell), Sturdy (armor), Nimble (speed), Plentiful (mining), Titanic (HP). Each supports a different playstyle.

- Gem tiers enabled: Rough, Cut, Flawless. The gem progression (Rough → Cut → Flawless) provides a satisfying vertical upgrade path. Each tier unlockable through Apotheosis's reforging mechanic.
- Gem types cover all primary stats: melee damage, projectile damage, magic damage, armor, max HP, mining speed, movement speed, luck. This ensures every build archetype benefits from gem-socketed gear.
- Socket count: Gear drops with 1-2 sockets by default. Reforging at the Smithing Table can add a 3rd socket at high rarity (Mythic+). This prevents socket overload while keeping the system meaningful.
- Boss modifiers: all active. Apothic Invaders and Elites spawn naturally with random affixes. They always drop affix items — this is the primary source of mythic gear.
- Rogue Spawners: enabled. Underground spawner+chest combos. Risk vs reward.
- Affix item probability: default rates (~5% base for rare+, scaling with luck and difficulty). Common-enough to feel rewarding, rare-enough to keep each upgrade exciting.

Enchanting module — `config/apotheosis/enchanting.cfg`:

- Keep all enchantment overhauls enabled: higher level cap (up to level 150+), tiered bookshelves (Hell, Seashelf, Endshelf), Library of Alexandria, new enchantments (Chromatic, Mounting, Stable Footing, etc.).
- The Library of Alexandria stores all enchanted books in one block — essential for enchanting organization at scale.
- Enchantment max levels increased for many vanilla enchantments: Protection can reach level 8, Sharpness level 6, Fortune level 5, Looting level 5, etc. These higher caps match the power fantasy curve — gear enchanted at max level should feel mythic.

Potion module:

- Potion Charms enabled: craft a charm from blaze powder + potions, equip in offhand for passive effect. Reduces inventory clutter from potion bottles.
- Potion augmentation allowed: glowing, brewing, changing base type into splash/lingering at standard ratios. Augmented potions can have higher level caps (e.g., Potion of Strength III).

Spawner module:

- Spawner capture and modification enabled. Silk-touch a spawner with a pickaxe, then modify it (entity type, spawn delay, player range, min/max entities). Key for XP farms and mob-based automation.
- Spawner stats are fully configurable after placement through the spawner's GUI (right-click with an empty hand). Players can fine-tune delay, count, range, and conditions per spawner — no external tool needed.

Village module:

- Wandering trader improvements enabled. Traders can sell Apotheosis items (gems, affix gear, enchanted books) at elevated prices. Adds a secondary acquisition path for players who prefer trading over combat.

Deadly module: Enabled. Apotheosis's Deadly module adds randomly generated death-traps to the world (sudden spikes, poison darts, instakill rooms, lava traps). This adds risk-reward tension to structure exploration — the deadliest rooms hold the best loot. The Deadly module's traps are telegraphed and avoidable with caution, and GraveStone Mod keeps your items safe if you do trigger one, so the chill rule is preserved.

Reforging costs — Apotheosis's reforging mechanic (reroll affixes with gem dust) uses default material costs. As the player progresses, reforging costs scale:

- Common→Uncommon: cheap (a few gem dust)
- Rare→Epic: moderate (dust + some ingots)
- Epic→Mythic: expensive (dust + rare materials like netherite scrap/echo shards)

This cost curve encourages the player to settle for "good enough" gear until they're ready to invest in perfect rolls.

New Dependencies (Wave 3)

Mod	Role
Placebo	Core library — required by Apotheosis
Apothic Attributes	Attribute system module — required by Apotheosis
Apothic-Enchanting	Enchanting module — required by Apotheosis
Apothic-Spawners	Spawner module — required by Apotheosis
Patchouli	Guidebook library — required by Apotheosis
Simply Tooltips	Tooltip framework — required by Simply Swords
Fuzzy Config	Config library — required by Simply Swords
Ranged Weapon API	Ranged combat API — required by Relics RPG and Skill Tree
Spell Engine	Magic framework — required by Relics RPG and Skill Tree
Bundle API	Bundle/container API — required by Runes

Interdependency notes for Wave 3

- **Spell Engine** is required by both Relics RPG and Skill Tree (RPG Series) — it was previously considered for removal but must be retained as a mandatory dependency of these core RPG mods.
- **Ranged Weapon API** is shared between Relics RPG and Skill Tree — install once, used by both.

Wave 4 — Food, Farming & Comfort

Mod	Role
Farmer's Delight 1.3.2	Cooking hub — cutting board, cooking pot, stove, new crops
Brewin' And Chewin' 4.5.0	Drinks and fermentation — beer, wine, mead, whiskey
Storage Delight 1.3.0	Kitchen furniture — drawers, cabinets, shelves for ingredient storage
More Delight 26.04.18a+1.21-neoforge	Extra meals, sandwiches, toasts, and knife variants

Mod	Role
My Nether's Delight 1.10.2	Nether-themed food ingredients and recipes
Ocean's Delight 1.0.4	Ocean-themed seafood dishes
Ender's Delight v1.3.0	End-themed food for Farmer's Delight (moved from Wave 2)

New Dependencies (Wave 4)

Mod	Role
Delight Lib 26.05.18-1.21-neoforge	Library — required by More Delight v26.04.30+ for cross-loader addon dev

Interdependency notes for Wave 4:

- Farmer's Delight meals provide status effects that stack with Brewin' And Chewin' drinks. Combined, a full meal + a vintage drink gives significant combat buffs — useful before boss fights (Wave 5).
- AE2's ME System can store Farmer's Delight ingredients and cooked meals. Set up an Export Bus on a cooking pot for automated ingredient delivery.
- Bountiful (Wave 4.5) can generate bounties that request Farmer's Delight meals as objectives, and reward cooking ingredients.
- My Nether's Delight, Ocean's Delight, and Ender's Delight unlock food sources from cross-dimensional ingredients (Nether, Overworld oceans, and End), giving reasons to explore every dimension beyond just combat.
- Storage Delight cabinets and drawers provide early-game kitchen storage that feeds into AE2 in Phase 2. They're designed as stepping stones, not replacements.
- More Delight v26.04.30+ requires **Delight Lib** as a hard dependency — install both or neither.

Wave 4.5 — Quests

Procedural bounty system that gives purpose to exploration and material collection without manual quest authoring.

Mod	Role
Bountiful 8.0.0-beta.2	Bounty boards in villages — procedurally generated fetch/kill/exploration quests with rewards

Bountiful generates quests automatically — find a bounty board in any village, accept tasks, earn rewards. Fully optional. Items from installed mods automatically appear in its reward pools.

Wave 5 — Combat & Mobs

Mod	Role
Better Combat	Melee combat animations — weapon reach, sweeping, attack speed

Mod	Role
Mutant Monsters	Mutant zombie, skeleton, creeper, enderman — unique drops
L_Ender's Cataclysm	Epic boss fights — Leviathan, Netherite Monstrosity, Ender Guardian (Modrinth, NeoForge 1.21.1)
When Dungeons Arise	Roguelike combat structures with loot
Enchantment Descriptions	Shows enchantment effects in tooltips
Create Big Cannons	Artillery engineering — siege cannons for colony defense and spectacle

Apotheosis also adds boss modifiers and elite mob affixes — partially covers what Champions would have done.

New Dependencies (Combat)

Mod	Role
Ritchie's Projectile Library	Library — custom projectiles and trajectories (Create Big Cannons)
playerAnimator	Animation library — required by Better Combat
Puzzles Lib	Library — required by Mutant Monsters
Citadel	Library — required by L_Ender's Cataclysm
Lionfish-API	Library — required by L_Ender's Cataclysm
Bookshelf	Library — required by Enchantment Descriptions

Better Combat + Simply Swords: Simply Swords weapons have built-in Better Combat data files — each weapon category uses the correct attack animation, reach, and speed automatically.

Wave 6 — Building & Decoration

Core Decoration

Mod	Role
Rechiseled	600+ decorative block variants with connected textures
Supplementaries	Vanilla+ decoration — jars, signposts, faucets, weather vanes
Macaw's Bridges	Bridges in all wood types
Macaw's Doors	Vanilla-style doors for every wood
Macaw's Roofs	Roofing blocks
Macaw's Windows	Window variants
Building Wands	Faster large-scale construction

Mod	Role
Handcrafted	Furniture — chairs, tables, shelves, curtains

Rechiseled Addons

Mod	Role
Rechiseled: Create	100+ decorative variants of Create blocks + mechanical chisel
Rechiseled: Applied Energistics 2	AE2 autocrafting for Rechiseled blocks via Chiseling Pattern Encoder

New Dependencies (Wave 6)

Mod	Role
Moonlight Library	Core library — required by Supplementaries
Resourceful Lib	Core library — required by Handcrafted
Fusion (Connected Textures)	Connected textures — required by Rechiseled

Wave 7 — Space Exploration

Core Space Mod

Mod	Role
Stellaris 1.4.23	Space exploration — rockets, Moon/Mars/Venus/Mercury/Glacio, oxygen system, machines, energy

Stellaris (by ExodusTeam) is the successor to Beyond Earth and the premier space mod for NeoForge 1.21.1. It features 4 rocket tiers, a rover, oxygen management, custom gravity per planet, oil/water/fuel processing, radioactives, and alien mobs. Machines include the Oxygen Distributor, Water Separator, Solar Panel, Fuel Refinery, and Pump Jack. 250+ building blocks across planet-specific sets.

Dependencies

Mod	Role
Architectury API	Cross-loader library (already in Wave 0)
Potentials API	Required library (Stellaris dependency)

Sky Aesthetics is embedded in Stellaris — no separate install needed.

Addons

Mod	Role
Create: TFMG — Stellaris Compat	Bridges TFMG diesel/gasoline into Stellaris rocket fuel (listed in Wave 1 as well)

Integration with Tech Mods

Layer	Stellaris ↔ Tech Mod Interaction
Power	Mekanism cables can power Stellaris machines. Create rotational → Mekanism → Stellaris
Energy	Mekanism universal cable connects to Stellaris machines (energy API compat)
Storage	AE2 ME drives store Stellaris materials; autocrafting builds rocket components
Transport	Create trains move space resources from landing pad to base. Sophisticated Backpacks carry oxygen tanks
Ore Processing	Mekanism 5x ore multiplication works on Stellaris ores (desh, ostranium, etc.)
Food	Farmer's Delight meals eatable in space when oxygen is present (v1.2.1+)
Gear	Apotheosis affixes may apply to Stellaris space suit (if item tags align)

Progression Placement

Phase 2 — Industrial Ascent (hours 40–200). Rockets require advanced materials that gate them behind Mekanism mid-game processing and AE2 infrastructure. Oxygen systems and fuel refining add a parallel supply-chain puzzle that rewards industrial automation.

Mod Count Summary

Wave	Mods	Deps	Total	Notes
Wave 0 — Foundation	49	8	57	Performance, QoL, storage, travel, graves, UI, chunk loading (+6 resource packs, 1 shaderpack, 1 data pack)
Wave 1 — Tech	8	—	8	Create + 4 addons, Mekanism, AE2, Nether & End Ores (TFMG-Stellaris compat listed in Wave 7 only)
Wave 1.5 — Colony	5	—	5	MineColonies (4 deps counted as mods — they're library mods)
Wave 2 — Exploration	20	5	25	YUNG's (9), Terralith/Tectonic, dimensions (3), End overhaul (2 + 5 deps), navigation, aircraft
Wave 3 — Equipment Magic	7	10	17	Skill Tree, Simply Swords, Relics, Runes, Curios, Apotheosis + 10 deps (Placebo, Apothic modules, Patchouli, Simply Tooltips, Fuzzy Config, Ranged Weapon API, Spell Engine, Bundle API)
Wave 4 — Food & Farming	7	—	7	Farmer's Delight + 6 addon mods (including Ender's Delight moved from Wave 2)
Wave 4.5 — Quests	1	—	1	Bountiful

Wave	Mods	Deps	Total	Notes
Wave 5 — Combat	6	6	12	Better Combat, Mutant Monsters, Cataclysm, Dungeons Arise, Big Cannons, Enchantment Descriptions + RPL lib, playerAnimator, Puzzles Lib, Citadel, Lionfish-API, Bookshelf
Wave 6 — Building	10	3	13	Rechiseled, Supplementaries, Macaw's (4), Building Wands, Handcrafted + Rechiseled: Create, Rechiseled: AE2 + Moonlight Lib, Resourceful Lib, Fusion
Wave 7 — Space Exploration	2	1	3	Stellaris, TFMG-Stellaris compat (moved from Wave 1), Potentials API
Total	114	34	148	All confirmed NeoForge 1.21.1